ZHIWEI (APRIL) LIN

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MCKINSEY & COMPANY Doha, Qatar
Business Analyst *Sep 2023 - Present*

AI STRATEGY & INVESTMENT

- Built the 5-year P&L model and GTM strategy for an AI assurance software venture under Qatar's national AI vehicle; prioritized entry markets based on demand forecast and feasibility, and designed tiered subscription-plus-module pricing; the business case secured $250M in funding from a Gulf sovereign wealth fund
- Developed the M&A and partnership strategy in AI data-center optical interconnects for a listed Taiwanese precision-connectivity provider; independently evaluated the market, technology pathways, and targets, shortlisted 8 U.S. photonics start-ups, and built investment memos that informed the chairman's acquisition decision
- Conducted commercial due diligence on a legal AI investment for a Gulf sovereign wealth fund; benchmarked model accuracy, hallucination and citation-verification performance, agentic workflows, security, and integration requirements, and assessed whether post-training and feedback loops created a defensible moat

STRATEGY, INVESTMENT & TRANSFORMATION

- Led global market sizing and synergy analysis for a Chinese irrigation leader's acquisition of an overseas drip-irrigation company; modeled approximately $200M in potential synergies, with findings later used in $1B+ fundraising efforts with multiple private-equity firms
- Supported a cross-border joint venture between a West African national oil company and a Chinese industrial group; built the negotiation strategy and playbook, aligned 30+ stakeholders from group CEO to executive vice president, and helped secure a memorandum of understanding
- Led a China channel-transformation workstream for a multinational crop-protection company; designed the target distribution model and channel-consolidation path, quantified operating costs and one-time investment, developed a phased implementation roadmap, and supervised one intern

EDUCATION

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY, COLUMBIA COLLEGE New York, NY
Bachelor of Arts in Economics–Philosophy; Minor in Psychology *Sep 2019 - May 2023*
GPA: 3.7/4.0 | Dean's List, all semesters
Relevant courses: Calculus III (A+), Statistics (A), Probability & Decision Theory (A-), Behavioral Economics (A-)
Extracurricular activities & roles: Columbia Global Ambassador; VP at Global China Connection; Dancer & Choreographer, including performing at New York Live Arts with Bessie Award-winning choreographer Ephrat Asherie

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

MCKINSEY CHINA–MIDDLE EAST CORRIDOR INITIATIVE Middle East & China
Core Team Member *Jun 2026 - Present*

- Co-drive McKinsey's China-Middle East corridor as an ongoing business-development initiative, collaborating biweekly with Partners and Senior partners across both regions to originate cross-boarder investment and commercial opportunities for Chinese companies in the Middle East
- Conducted deep dives across 5+ priority sectors – including energy, automotive, robotics, and AI –developed market-entry perspectives, mapped prospective clients and local partners, and assessed partnership models; coordinated itineraries for 2 cross-border client visits, helping convert the opportunity pipeline into 3 client engagements

QIJIA AI FAMILY COACH - *Early-stage nonprofit AI venture* Hangzhou, China
Volunteer Product & User Researcher *Dec 2025 - Present*

- Help build Qijia, a free, open-source AI family coach providing parenting and mental-health guidance to parents with limited access to affordable resources by conducting 15 user interviews and translating Alpha user insights into 3 new product features for the Beta launch
- Supported a product serving 16,500+ registered users (2,700+ monthly active), with ~2,500 five-star conversation ratings from ~1,200 users

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent) | Interests: Dance, Tennis, Improv comedy
- Moved independently to Jordan at 16; studied Dabkeh's role in Palestinian identity and performed before King Abdullah II; supported exhibition curation at the National Gallery of Jordan, focusing on women artists in the Arab world